

Introduction

Urticaria. Allergic rashes. A skin disease. The appearance of intensity itching wheels over the body, having elevated centers surrounded by the patches of redness is identified as *Śītapitta*. The wheels tend to disappear in a day or two and sometimes accompanied by fever, vomiting and burning sensation. *Śītapitta* is caused by contact with very cold breeze, *kapha* and *vāta* getting increased, along with *pitta* also begin to travel externally in the skin and internally in blood and other tissue. Prodromal features of the disease include feeling of thirst, loss appetite, oppression in the chest, debility, heaviness of the body and redness of the eyes are its symptoms.

शीतमारुतसंस्पर्शात्प्रदुष्टौ कफमारुतौ ।
पित्तेन सह सम्भूय बहिरन्तर्विसर्पतः ॥

M.Ni. 50/1

Kapha and *Vāta* become aggravated due to exposure to cold breeze circulating all over the body (i.e. both externally & internally) in association with *pitta* causes *Śītapitta*.

शीतपित्त पूर्वरूप (Śīta-Pitta Pūrvarupa)

पिपासाऽरुचिहृल्लासदेहसादाङ्गौरवम् । रक्तलोचनता
तेषां पूर्वरूपस्य लक्षणम् ॥

M.Ni. 50/2

Premonitory signs of symptoms of *Śītapitta* are thirst, anorexia, oppression in the chest, debility, heaviness & reddishness of eyes.

शीतपित्त लक्षण (Udarda/Śīta-Pitta Lakṣana)

वरटीदृष्टसंस्थानः शोथः संजायते बहिः ।
सकण्डूस्तोदबहुलश्छर्दिज्वरविदाहवान् ॥

उदरमिति तं विद्याच्छीतपित्तमथापरे ।
वाताधिकं शीतपित्तमुदरस्तु कफाधिकः ॥

M.Ni. 50/3-4

Skin eruption which are elevated resemble like that produced by the sting of the wasp, associated with severe itching, pricking pain, vomiting, fever, burning sensation are the characteristic features of *Udarda* & some people says it as the *Śītapitta*. Prominent distinguishing feature between *Udarda* and *Śītapitta* is predominance of *Doṣas* i.e. *Vāta* is predominant in *Śītapitta* while in *Udarda* *Kapha* is predominant.

उदर (Udarda)

सोत्सङ्गैश्च सरागैश्च कण्डूमद्भिश्च मण्डलैः ।
शैशिरः कफजो व्याधिरुदर इति कीर्तितः ॥

M.Ni. 50/5

Udarda is characterised by elevated, reddish, highly irritating, round patches produced by *Kapha* during *Śīśira ṛtu*.

कोठ (Koṭha)

असम्यग्वमनोदीर्णपित्तश्लेष्मान्ननिग्रहेः ।
मण्डलानि सकण्डूनि रागवन्ति बहूनि च ।
उत्कोठः सानुबन्धश्च कोठ इत्यभिधीयते ॥

M.Ni. 50/6

Koṭha manifest due to improper administration of emesis, suppression of the movement of *Pitta*, *Kapha*, & *Anna* causes the development of innumerable rashes which are red associated with itching & relapse many times. This is known as *Koṭha*.

Differential diagnosis of Śītapitta, Udarda and Koṭha

S.No.	Śītapitta	Udarda	Koṭha
Doṣa Etiology	Vāta predominance exposure to cold breeze Kapha and Vāta become aggravated due to exposure to cold breeze circulating all over the body (i.e. both externally & internally) in association with pitta causes Śītapitta	Kapha predominance Excess Kapha during Śīṣira ṛtu	Pitta, Kapha nighraha Koṭha manifest due to improper administration of emesis, suppression of the movement of Pitta, Kapha, & Anna
Clinical presentation	Skin eruption which are elevated resemble like that produced by the sting of the wasp, associated with severe itching, pricking pain, vomiting, fever, burning sensation	Udarda is characterized by elevated, reddish, highly irritating, round patches produced by Kapha during Śīṣira ṛtu.	Developments of innumerable rashes which are red associated with itching & relapse many times. This is known as Koṭha
Contemporary	Hives /Urticaria	Hives /Urticaria	Rashes

MCQs

1. Raktalochana is seen in

- Sitapitta Rupa
- Sitapitta Purvarupa
- Udarda
- Koṭha

2. Dosha predominance of Udarda

- Vatapradhanatridosha

b. Pitta pradhanatridosha

c. Kaphapradhanatridosha

d. Samasannipatika

3. Varadidashtasamsthana is the feature of

a. Sitapitta

b. Udarda

c. Koṭha

d. Utkoṭha

Answer

1.	b	2.	c	3.	a
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